

events in recent times - the 2016 Presidential Election.

The general consensus (online) about the alt-right (or conservatives or whatever you might call the side that won) was that their arguments are silly, baseless and easily seen through A.K.A trolling. Hence the widespread reaction to those very arguments was outright dismissal. But not doing anything about that eventually led to the general populace of the country into believing the satire-laden trolling to be genuine facts in most cases. Just like how Facebook's fake news problem, triggered by switching trending topics to a purely algorithmic process from human curation, was unable to distinguish baseless trends from genuine news and ended up influencing a lot of people. If this does not instate the validity of Poe's law, we don't know what will.

On the other hand, outright denial or declaration of your victory online also loses you any argument that you might involved in because of the exact same reasons. Danth's law (see box) comes into action more often than you think it does, and if you stay behind to check whether your declaration has been accepted by others in the argument or not, even after you've declared you're leaving, you'd be fulfilling Shaker's law. Still believe that there isn't an unseen set of rules that govern the memes, and your, behaviour?



MEME - THE UNIVERSAL TOOL

While most of our mental schema is wired to keep us focussed and occupied with what's at hand, memes, with their inherent imageability and repetitive nature, help us process abstractions faster. While this is beneficial, abstraction also leads to an unavoidable problem: we begin to view memes as concrete units, where they are not. This is what lets us be able to wage an actual war against an abstract idea ('terrorism') or a particular class of chemical compounds ('drugs'). This leads to belief systems that are not entirely robust against questioning or dire situations, in which we unconsciously propagate

THE RULES OF THE INTERNET

While some of the maxims that apply to the internet have been mentioned in the article, here is an expanded list of what we believe to be the governing rules of online behavior:

BADGER'S LAW

Websites with the word "Truth" in the URL have none in the posted content.

DANTH'S LAW

If you have to insist that you've won an Internet argument, you've probably lost badly.

GODWIN'S LAW

As an online discussion grows longer, the probability of a comparison involving Hitler approaches 1

POE'S LAW

Without a clear indication of the author's intent, it is difficult or impossible to tell the difference between an expression of sincere extremism and a parody of extremism.

RULE 34

If it exists, there's porn of it

SKITT'S LAW

Any post correcting an error in another post will contain at least one error itself

LAW OF EXCLAMATION

The more exclamation points used in an email (or other posting), the more likely it is a complete lie. This is also true for excessive capital letters.

COHEN'S LAW

Whoever resorts to the argument

"whoever resorts to the argument that... has automatically lost the debate" has automatically lost the debate.

SHAKER'S LAW

Those who egregiously announce their imminent departure from an Internet discussion forum almost never actually leave.

SKARKA'S LAW

On internet messageboards, there is no subject so vile or indefensible that someone won't post positively/in defense of it.

SHANK'S LAW

The imaginative powers of the human mind have yet to rise to the challenge of concocting a conspiracy theory so batshit insane that one cannot find at least one Ph.D holding scientist to support it.

WIO'S LAW

Communication usually fails, except by accident

STURGEON'S LAW

90% of everything is crap

THE 1% RULE

The 1% rule states that the number of people who create content on the Internet represents approximately 1% of the people actually viewing that content.

CUNNINGHAM'S LAW

The best way to get the right answer on the Internet is not to ask a question, it's to post the wrong answer.

those very memes. And generally, these are simple, catchy, easy-to-grasp ideas - just because they are easier to retain and rehearse.

Acknowledging the meme in its true form - as a connected pseudo-organism that influences individual, and in turn, social behaviour can be more beneficial than you think. As an analogy, the first step you take against a virus outbreak is acknowledge that there is an outbreak. It's just that in

this case, the outbreak can be controlled to influence certain people in certain ways. And these unseen rules, which perhaps now you'll be more perceptive to, benefit the understanding, hence predictability, of how memes behave. This underlying system, this blueprint to the organism that now lies on the fringes of awareness when it comes to the general populace, will someday be viewed as what shaped the world as we will know it. **d**